always, the bureaucrats responded by telling states, cities, counties, and schools *how* to spend this money.

In Madison's words, Washington was usurping power from the states by the "gradual and silent encroachment of those in power."

In ever greater amounts, federal handouts started cascading to states and communities, often for programs they had no need or desire for, but they took the money because it was *there;* it seemed to be "free."

Over time, they became so dependent on the money that, like junkies, they found it all but impossible to break the habit, and only after they were well addicted to it did they learn how pervasive the federal regulations were that came with the money.

As all this was going on, the federal government was taking an ever-increasing share of the nation's total tax revenues and making it more difficult for states and local governments to raise money on their own; as a result, they had to turn even more to the federal government for financial aid and became the captives of a relentless Washington and its multitude of bureaucracies. In return for federal grants, state and local governments surrendered control of their destiny to a faceless bureaucracy in Washington that claimed to know better how to solve the problems of a city or town than the people who lived there. And if local officials or their congressmen ever tried to end a program they didn't like or they thought was unproductive and wasteful, they discovered that the beneficiaries of the program and the bureaucrats who administered it had formed such a tight alliance that it was all but impossible for elected officials to kill it. Once started, a federal program benefiting *any* group or special interest is virtually impossible to end and the costs go on forever.

We had strayed a great distance from our founding fathers' vision of America: They regarded the central